Unit 6 Entrepreneurship in the Digital Age

Problem → idea → prototype → MVP → beachhead market

LOW / MID / HIGH FIDELITY | PROTOTYPE ≠ MVP | RISKIEST ASSUMPTION | CANTEEN CASE

Teacher note from the book: do not memorise definitions. Pick a small problem, talk to users, draw, collect feedback, improve.

0. The journey is the syllabus

An **entrepreneur** notices a problem and builds a product or service — sometimes from a phone, an Instagram catalogue, or a WhatsApp price list. **Entrepreneurship** is the practice of planning, starting, testing, and improving, with creativity, risk, and a wish to last. The digital age makes the first test cheap: forms, payments, social posts, paper screenshots.



Figure 6.1 in the textbook: from a pain people already have, to the first paying (or using) customers.

Figure 1. Do not start at “the app”. Start at the problem sentence.

Local idea sparks from the book: fee reminders, an Ajrak catalogue, test reminders, canteen pre-order, van-delay updates, a notes hub.

1. Prototype — a thing you can point at

A **prototype** is an early model that shows how the idea looks and might work. It does *not* have to function. Paper, chart paper, Canva, Figma, PowerPoint, phone screenshots all count — including in a low-resource classroom with no lab.

Table 1. Fidelity (Table 6.3)

Type	Detail	Example	Purpose
Low-fi	Rough	Hand-drawn screens	Is the idea understandable?
Mid-fi	Clearer layout	Clickable PPT / Figma	Can people navigate?
High-fi	Near-final look	Working demo form	Does it feel real?

1.1 The build loop

DESIGN
Who is it for? What one job?

BUILD
The cheapest thing that can be shown.

TEST
Watch real people. Shut up while they try.

ITERATE
Change the drawing. Repeat. This is not failure.

ClassBuddy / Homework Helper activity: interview `10` students, draw paper screens, test with `5` classmates, then fix the button that nobody could find, add a subject filter, add a weekly view. That sequence *is* the lesson.

2. MVP — the smallest thing that is actually used

A **Minimum Viable Product** has the fewest features that still let a real person complete the core job. A Google Form that takes canteen orders for three days is an MVP. A colour-perfect app that nobody has ordered from is not.

Table 2. Prototype versus MVP (Table 6.6)

	Prototype	MVP
Question	Is the idea understandable?	Will they actually use it?
Must it work?	No	Yes, basically
Audience	A few testers, design talk	Early real users
Cost	Almost nothing	Still low; some building
Canteen example	Paper screens of a menu	Live form + pickup line for 3 days

2.1 Riskiest assumption

Every idea sits on beliefs. The **riskiest assumption** is the belief that, if false, kills the idea. “Students will pay for tutoring” is riskier than “we can pick a blue theme”. Test the killer belief first, with an MVP, not with a logo.

2.2 Planning an MVP

Write: the problem, the first users, *one* core feature, the cheap tools, how you will tell those users it exists, how you will collect feedback, and what you will change next. Estimate a small cost (paper, mobile data, a canteen receipt book) — not a startup fantasy budget.

3. Case — canteen pre-order

1. Pain: the whole college arrives at once; the last row gets leftovers.
2. Paper prototype of a 5-item menu and a pickup slip.
3. MVP: Google Form (or a paper register). Orders close 20 minutes before break. Separate pickup line.
4. Run three days. Count completed orders, no-shows, kitchen stress.
5. Iterate: drop the two dishes nobody wants; send a reminder; keep the menu tiny.

4. Beachhead market — start embarrassingly small

A **beachhead** is the first tiny market you can actually win. “All students in Pakistan” is a slogan. “Grade XII board-prep students in *this* college” is a beachhead. “One canteen, one break” is a beachhead. Win a beach, then hop to the next cove.

Table 3. Weak versus strong first market

Too broad	Focused beachhead
Every student in the country	XII pre-board students, one campus
All city canteens	Our canteen, 10:40 break

Other project seeds: notice organiser, lost-and-found, library-book checker, crafts order form. Stay ethical: permission, no scraped personal data, no fake “sold out” tricks, no spam to a class group.

Self-check

1. A clickable Figma of a van-tracker with no live GPS — prototype or MVP?
2. Name a riskiest assumption for a paid notes hub.
3. Rewrite “an app for all Pakistani students” as a beachhead sentence.

Answers. (1) Prototype (it cannot yet be used for a real van). (2) “Students will pay rather than photocopy.” (3) e.g. “XII Computer Science students in this college who missed last week’s practical.”

Recap

1. Entrepreneurship here is a loop, not a vocabulary test.
2. Problem → idea → prototype → MVP → beachhead.
3. Fidelity: low / mid / high. Paper is a legal prototype.
4. Prototype asks “clear?”; MVP asks “used?”.
5. Test the riskiest assumption first. Start with a market small enough to name in one breath.
6. Collect feedback, change the thing, stay ethical.

Interview five people about one annoyance. Draw three low-fi screens before you open a laptop.